Falls Creek Ranch Board Meeting

Status: Approved **Date:** Sep 28, 2026 4:00 PM MDT **Location:** Online

Video call link: https://meet.google.com/yxh-huud-jmy
Or dial: (US) +1 262-864-1592 PIN: 469 558 732#
More phone numbers: https://tel.meet/yxh-huud-jmy?pin=9208654690166

Attendees

- **Board Members:** Justin Poehnelt, Pamela Flowers, Pat Fettinger
- **Guests:** Christian Heine, Mary Ann Bryant, Barry Bryant, Gale Marinelli, James Grizzard, David McCament, Bobbie Baird, Steve Dowler, Nancy Henry

Approval/Changes to the Agenda

-

Conflicts of Interest

-

Open Period Comments

- Request Board update on status of rewritten governance policies - Mary Ann Bryant
- Request Board update on status of updated Horse Committee Rules - Mary Ann Bryan
- Issue related to bird nest boxes in meadows - Mary Ann Bryant - Some need to be relocated.
- Quick update on gate requested by Bobbie Baird. Discussion was overwhelmingly positive for the gate. Also suggested to have the gate closed more than just summer lake use.
- Gale Marinelli asked about the Water Tank access road. *No update is available at this time.*

Approval of Previous Minutes

Pamela Flowers motioned to approve, Pat Fettinger seconded. Motion approved.

Treasurer's Report as of September 28, 2026

Capital Acct	52,450	General
	82,774	Water
Operating	201,017	
JP Morgan Investment	150,000	Water capital funds.
TOTAL	**486,241**	

Still a few outstanding HOA assessments, approximately $18,000.

The reserve study committee, consisting of Pamela Flowers, Mary Ann Bryant, Lisa Bayer and Robin Lucie met with Robbie Pepper, a Reserve Study Specialist, on Sept. 22nd to review all of the FCR HOA assets and tour the Ranch.

There will be further discussion at various steps of this process before conclusions are accepted. A final report may be completed by the end of the year to be used for next year's annual budget. Some of the discussion was around mitigating risks and funding activities relating to those risks.

Topics of discussion included:

- 100 lots & 97 homes
- Water is in house
- 840 acres of common property (easements can be an issue for some neighborhoods)
- Reserve Funding: 50% is considered break even and 70% is good
- Capital Expenditures are funds reserved for existing capital items, and do not have to be voted on by the residents (owners).
- Capital Improvements are new items and have to be approved by the majority.

- Main Road is 3 years old with a 7-year loan, financed in house.
- An example of a “Reserve Fund” item would be an appliance allocation for the Ranch house- 5 years at $5,000
- There will be a Capital Software program that we will have access to, according to Robbie.
- Sale of equipment should be put into a reserve account for replacement of assets or purchase of a new one.
- An HOA should never have to move money from Capital Accounts to Operating
- Discussed the water rights downstream and common property culverts
- HOAs should always have a “Contingency Fund” for emergencies
- Firewise Maintenance plan- when you check on things… yearly
- Maintenance program for equipment - what, where, when and cost.
- Create an easy system for the future residents to use.
- Discussed the water infrastructure: four community wells, fifth well drilled but not in use, two treatment buildings, two 60,000 gallon water tanks.
- Cost of water pump replacement-$10k per pump.
- 7 miles of water lines throughout the ranch, which are 40-50 years old and will need replacing as they fail.

The Reserve Study will anticipate needs 30 years into the future. Robbie took lots of photos and will begin work on our study in the next 6-8 weeks, as he is finishing up two other studies at this time. I will give him an updated copy of all of our assets with the depreciation schedules for 2026-27. We expect to have a rough draft of his proposal around Dec-Jan. He will send out the proposal to the committee and Board for review. There can be up to three versions that go out before anything is finalized. All of the Board members and the Reserve Study Committee will have an opportunity for input on the report. We are not required to implement any of his findings, as it is simply an assessment of where we are from a financial and liability standpoint, and where we should be in order to operate as efficiently and effectively as possible for the benefit of all the home owners present and future.

Justin Poehnelt motioned to approve the Treasurer’s report. Pat Fettinger seconded the motion. The motion passed.

Committee Reports

Common Property

A number of fallen and threatening trees were removed very close to residents' properties or homes over the past month. Thanks to Kern and crew for doing this safely and efficiently.

There was a community workday to clear undergrowth and create a firebreak along the west side of Falls Creek Main this past Saturday with about 30 residents participating in chipping, weeding and hauling slash. Thank you to everyone who showed up to help!

The La Plata County burn ban has been lifted. We plan to 'catch up' with this summer's slash, which has been accumulating at the slash yard. The work day addressed one of the two outstanding grants. Once the grants covering the west side of Falls Creek Main are complete, we will address the second grant east of Oakcrest.

To all residents, hiking the meadows and trails after the rains is an opportune time to pull weeds; they come out very easily. FYI, there are a significant number of large thistles in the lower meadow next to the lake, if anyone is interested in working on those. They are also all along the meadow trail.

Roads

The chip seal contractor will finally be arriving to repair potholes, repair worn edges on Main, and chipseal over earlier repairs before the end of September. This will be good preparation for the coming winter season, which hopefully, will be a snowy one.

Side roads have been holding up well and have been graded as necessary by Geary using the Kubota tractor and blade. We will be adding road base and Mag Chloride in Spring, as needed.

FireWise

No report.

Trails

No report.

Community Garden

We are asking all participating gardeners to pick their ripe tomatoes: there are around 100 tomatoes that need to come off of the plant. Check your other crops as well! There will be a final clean-up and gathering soon. Look for an email from your committee chairs if you are a participating gardener.

Architecture

There are currently 12 open projects on the Ranch.

Bees and Chickens

Chris Heine Powerpoint presentation. Ditch south of the orchard helps the Orchard drain. Gophers have not been a significant issue. A cistern and solar pump were put in place this year. However, no fruit due to the early warm spell and late freeze.

Electric fence presentation. Modern energizes use higher voltage and fraction of an amp delivered for a brief pulse with a capacitor. Single wire wrapped around the orchard twice, with fence insulators attached to posts.

Discussion around insurance, risks, and future conversation with the residents.

Dam

We have wrapped up summer maintenance operations and our lake and dam are in great shape.

When full, FCR lake covers 42 Surface acres and; has a holding capacity of 472 Acre feet or about 154 million gallons of water.

Throughout summer, we release water at a rate of about 1.35 million gallons a week and today our lake is 36 inches below full. This time of year, it's not unusual or ideal that our lake is 3 feet below capacity, it's math. Like everybody else in Colorado, we are betting

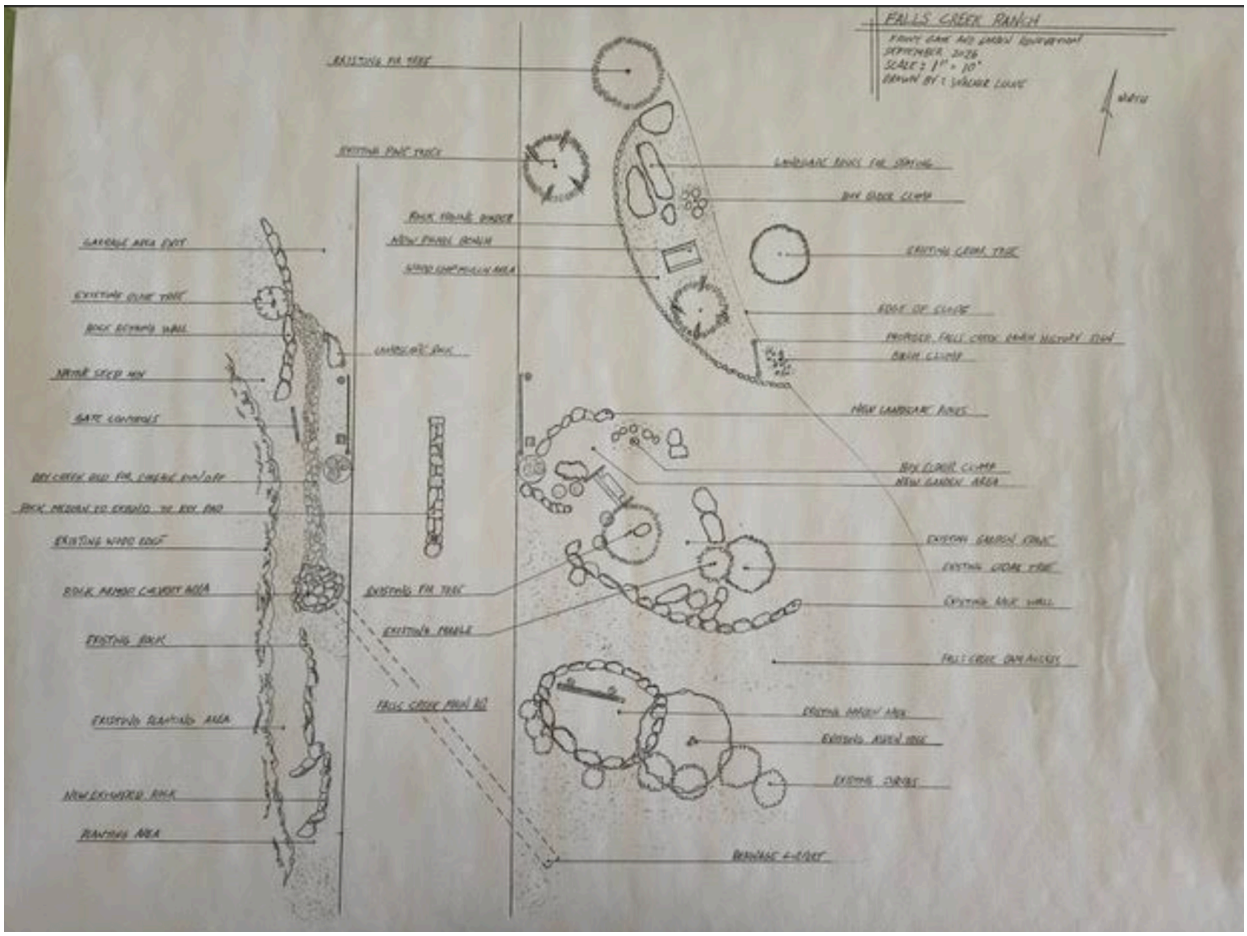
heavily on a big snow year, it will help to fill our lake next spring.

Will be exploring hydro-mulching and irrigated vegetation for the dam.

Front Entrance Plans

Walker Lowe, a member of the Front Entrance Committee, has drawn up our plans to extend and enhance the existing garden areas. We would like to add a viewing area for a fantastic lake and mountain view, including a small sign about FCR, a built-in seating area made of stone from the ranch, and a small footpath connecting this area to the existing northeast side of the garden. We will begin with plans for beautifying the area around the gateposts as well, now that the bulk of the installation is complete, pending the burying of the wire bundle near the gate mechanism. We have ordered bulbs for fall planting in hope of some nice early spring blooms. Weeding Wednesdays will cease for the season, but we will have a final big workday to tidy, trim, and mulch the existing garden areas.

You may have noticed that Bill Rebovich rebuilt the dry-stack stone surrounds at the Firehouse garden. This was a great improvement and will provide solid infrastructure for new plantings. Thank you, Bill!



Emergency Response Team

No report.

Horses

We have a new foster horse named Juniper that has temporarily joined the herd. She will be with us until she is able to find a permanent home. If you happen to see her, please stop and say “hello” as she is very sweet. Please remember not to feed any of the horses “treats” without the owner’s permission.

Lake

Work Day is to be rescheduled. Stay tuned- new date likely mid October when we order sand and the rain clears. We have a new weed razor to try out and a weed rake to keep our

beaches weed free. We will also be trimming junipers, making our beaches beautiful and doing the usual repair and upkeep.
Keep an eye out for the lake workday flyer- we look forward to a great turnout and have lots of leftover ice cream to share!

Past news: if you didn't make it to the lake for our parties this summer you missed out!
The ukulele party was a blast!
The Ice cream social was adorable! (Thanks to everyone who helped and participated.)
Also, the new Healing Circle Music Concert with Sara Tone was beautiful. Thank you to Christina for organizing that gathering.

Reminder- If you are leaving for the winter please bring home your boats, paddles and oars!

Utilities

The leakage rate from the lower system has been reduced dramatically after the waterline repairs made at Dyke Canyon Trail and the Corral. We have two non-functioning water meters and have ordered replacements. If the old meters can be fixed, we will put them back in service with our next meter replacement program. We contacted CROM/MW regarding the schedule for tank coating and hatch replacements. It looks like late October at the earliest. The work should only take 2 days with good weather. Chris Heine is coordinating with Clint Brooks/Well Driller to swap out the pump in the new well for a smaller one that allows control of the flow for final testing of production.

Welcome

New Resident, Sharon Banik moved in last week. She purchased Glover's home at 64 Starwood Trail. When you get a chance, please stop by and welcome her to the Ranch. She is recently retired and decided to make a change from Salt Lake City to Durango. She will be a wonderful addition to our community.

Ranch Manager

No report.

Old Business

- Mary Ann Bryant: Record retention. No substantial change in the status of this work. *No action taken.*
- Trail concern from one resident. The discussion stated that the resident is free to continue using the old path if they prefer. *No action taken.*
- Discussion about the lease and policy modification for the stables.

New Business

- Board Authorization Letter for BSJ to update names on the account. - *Pat Fettinger stated that he has signed and will send to Justin Poehnelt for a second signature.*

Executive Session

- Ongoing legal discussions regarding the access road to the north water tank.
- Committee membership discussion and the responsibility of the Board to oversee membership in these committees.

Announcements

- Email board@fallscreekranch.org if interested in serving on the Falls Creek Ranch Board.
- See https://fallscreekranch.org/residents/calendar for future Board Meetings
- Join the FCR Slack
- We are in need of a new Committee Chairperson for the Tennis/Pickleball Committee, if anyone is interested. There are funds available for repairs and “beautification” of the premises. Please let the Board know if you are interested in this position, board@fallscreekranch.org.